Doctors say these programmes work better because menopause affects multiple systems at once. Dr Yashica Gudesar, director and unit head of obstetrics and gynaecology at Max Super Speciality Hospital, Dwarka, New Delhi, says that good menopause care must be continuous and personalised rather than limited to one consultation. Evaluating bone health, heart risk, metabolic changes and mental well-being alongside symptom management helps prevent complications that often appear years later.

The Indian Menopause Society works through more than 64 societies across India and over 6,500 members to conduct medical education programmes, webinars and public awareness initiatives on menopausal health. "Our guiding idea is simple: women should be fit at 40, strong at 60, and independent at 80," says Dr Shah.

Digital platforms are also emerging as important entry points for women unsure whether symptoms are menopause-related. Femtech companies now offer symptom tracking, teleconsultations and expert-led education. Miror operates menopause-focused communities where women exchange experiences and attend sessions on sleep and hormonal health. Other startups are building structured clinical pathways. Miyara Health offers a digital companion helping women over 35 track hormonal health across sleep, mood and metabolism while connecting them to expert-led solutions. Companies such as Elda Health combine consultations with peer support networks and lifestyle programmes addressing sleep and mental health, while Proactive For Her now offers menopause consultations alongside preventive screenings. Nutrition-focused platforms such as Earthful provide dietary and supplement guidance tailored to hormonal transitions and metabolic shifts.

Integrative medicine is also entering mainstream discussion. In late 2025, VMMC–Safdarjung Hospital partnered with the Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences to develop evidence-based integrative menopause protocols, combining lifestyle approaches such as yoga and dietary guidance with modern screening for heart, bone and metabolic health.

Most importantly, women are beginning to talk about menopause. Bollywood celebrities like Soha Ali Khan, Twinkle Khanna and Lisa Ray are lending their names to the cause. And if Akshay mainstreamed menstruation in the film *Pad Man*, Bollywood explored menopause with the heartwarming *Me No Pause Me Play*, a film about three women not letting their menopausal travails come in the way of running a marathon. Gujarati cinema, too, gave audiences *Jalebi Rocks* last year, where the film's protagonist rediscovers her worth even as she navigates menopause and a busy life.

Menopause Care for All

While these developments together signal the emergence of a menopause care ecosystem India long lacked, access remains uneven. Services are still concentrated in large cities, leaving women in smaller towns dependent on doctors who may lack menopause-specific training, while specialised consultations and diagnostic tests remain costly and often uninsured.

This gap often leads to self-medication. Many women, says Dr Gupta, begin taking over-the-counter supplements marketed for menopause relief, including calcium, vitamin D, herbal formulations or phytoestrogen products, or even start hormone replacement therapies based on advice from friends or online forums. And unsupervised menopause management, she warns, can do more harm than good. "Improper or unsupervised use can worsen existing risks such as blood pressure, metabolic issues or clotting tendencies, and sometimes mask underlying problems that need treatment," she explains.

But awareness, and support, are growing. For women, it will mean the difference between years lost to confusion and years lived in good health. ■

MANAGING MENOPAUSE

Medical check-ups
- Hormone and symptom assessment
- Bone density screening
- Cholesterol, sugar and heart risk checks

Hormone-friendly diet
- Protein-rich meals for muscle and metabolism
- Calcium and Vitamin D for bone health
- Fibre-rich foods for digestion and weight control

Movement & exercise
- Strength training for bone and muscle health
- Walking, yoga or cardio for heart fitness
- Stretching for joint stiffness

Sleep & stress care
- Fixed sleep schedule
- Reduce screen use before bedtime
- Stress reduction through yoga, meditation or breathing

Medical treatments
- Doctor-guided hormone therapy if suitable
- Non-hormonal medicines for sleep, mood or hot flashes
- Targeted supplements prescribed after testing



"MENOPAUSE AFFECTS FAR MORE THAN REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH. IT MARKS A MAJOR HORMONAL SHIFT THAT IMPACTS ALMOST EVERY SYSTEM IN THE BODY"

DR YASHICA GUDESAR
Director; Unit Head, Obstetrics and Gynaecology, Max Super Speciality Hospital, Dwarka, New Delhi